

openMemo

Install, and the first launch

Install

Drag **openMemo** onto the **Applications** folder in this window. That is the whole install. Getting past the first launch is one line in Terminal, or four clicks.

Then macOS blocks it once, and that is expected

openMemo is not notarised, because notarising needs a paid Apple developer account this project does not have. macOS refuses the first launch of every app it cannot check, and makes you allow it by hand. Nothing is wrong with the download.

The one line way

A browser marks what it downloads with a hidden quarantine tag, and that tag is what macOS reacts to. Remove it and openMemo simply opens. Copy this line, paste it into **Terminal**, press return:

```
xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine /Applications/OpenMemo.app
```

Terminal lives in **Applications/Utilities**, or press Command-Space and type its name. The line prints nothing when it works, which is the normal outcome. Run it again after each update.

openMemo

The click-only way

Four steps, once per version

For anyone who would rather not touch Terminal. Every one of these dialogs is macOS talking about an app it cannot check, and none of them mean the download is damaged.

1 Open openMemo from Applications

macOS refuses, and this dialog offers no way through. Click **Done**. Do not click Move to Bin.

“OpenMemo” Not Opened

Apple could not verify “OpenMemo” is free of malware that may harm your Mac or compromise your privacy.

Done

Move to Bin

2 Open System Settings, then Privacy & Security

Apple menu, **System Settings**, **Privacy & Security** in the sidebar. Scroll down to **Security**. openMemo is named there, with a button beside it. Click **Open Anyway**.

“OpenMemo” was blocked to protect your Mac.

Open Anyway

That line only appears after step 1, and it fades after a while. If it is not there, try opening the app again.

3 Confirm with Touch ID or your password

macOS checks that you own the Mac.

You are attempting to open an app that may cause harm to your Mac

Touch ID or enter an administrator’s name and password to continue with Privacy & Security.

Use Password...

Cancel

4 Say yes one last time

A final dialog appears, this one with a way through. Click **Open Anyway**. openMemo starts, and it starts normally from now on.

Open “OpenMemo”?

Apple is not able to verify that it is free from malware that could harm your Mac or compromise your privacy.

Move to Bin

Open Anyway

Done

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After the first launch

If you set a PIN lock

openMemo keeps the PIN as a hash in its own settings file, inside your library folder. No keychain, no login password, no access to anything else on your Mac.

Updating from 3.22.0 or older? Those builds did keep the PIN in the keychain, which is why macOS asked for your login password after every update. Reading that old PIN back needs the same panel, so openMemo throws it away instead and says so on first launch. Set a new PIN in **Settings**, under **App lock**. Nothing else is touched.

Updating later

openMemo checks GitHub for new versions and offers to download the new `.dmg` for you. When one arrives:

- 1 Quit openMemo first**
Command-Q. The backend holds the database open.
- 2 Drag the new openMemo onto Applications and replace**
Finder asks whether to replace. Say yes.
- 3 Allow it again**

A fresh download carries a fresh block, so page one applies to every update, not only the first install, and it stays that way until openMemo has an Apple developer account of its own. The one line is the quickest way through:

```
xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine /Applications/OpenMemo.app
```

openMemo

Your library, and why this app is unsigned

Your library is not inside the app

Everything you keep lives in `~/Library/Application Support/OpenMemo/`, so replacing the app replaces the program and nothing else. openMemo also copies the library into its `backups` folder before the first launch of a new version.

Never delete that folder to reinstall cleanly. That folder is your library. Throwing away the app is harmless. Throwing away that folder is not.

About those blocked launches

Stopping macOS from questioning openMemo means an Apple Developer Program membership: \$99 a year, forever, for a free app that makes nothing. That is the only reason page two exists, and it is the first thing any support would pay for.

If openMemo earns its place on your Mac

github.com/sponsors/izored • buymeacoffee.com/izored

Full documentation: github.com/izored/OpenMemo, [docs/MACOS.md](https://github.com/izored/OpenMemo/blob/master/docs/MACOS.md). openMemo is MIT licensed, runs entirely on your Mac, and sends your library nowhere.